

**May 26, 2021
5 to 7 PM
Via Zoom
Buildings and Grounds Subcommittee Notes**

Roll: Chair Kathy Kreatz, Members Paulette Van der Kloot and Paul Ruseau present, 0 Absent

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Dr. Marice Edouard Vincent, Dr. Peter Cushing, Chad Fallon, John McLaughlin, David Murphy, Lisa Evangelista, Aggie, Sean Beagan Mr. Cormio, Alicia Hunt

Chad Fallon: Sharing Screen Mr. Rich Cormio, the electrical teacher also joining in

Presentation link here

Over \$1 million has been spent on improving the MVTHS since Mr. Fallon has joined the staff

Highlighted projects are done by students: landscaping entrance, cement work, wiring of space in Voch, kitchen design in the works. Repurposed the culinary space that wasn't being used. Will be used for the electrical classroom.

Chad Fallon: We have asked for an additional electrical teacher to make 3 teachers which are more in line with the other vocational schools in the area.

Paulette Van der Kloot: The kids being able to wire a kitchen is fantastic. The outside looks so much better.

Kathy Kreatz: The presentation was phenomenal. The student projects are wonderful. It was great to see the student and CTE shop collaboration with Construction and Craft Labor Carpentry students. The two programs worked together and prepared for the new cement sidewalk outside of the vocational door. Very excited to hear about the New House in electrical in preparation for the expansion of the electrical program. 12 additional student work booths. Additionally, doing something unique; there is one room that was left wide open. They will use this room to learn how to wire a kitchen with a stove, refrigerator, etc. Very exciting things happening in the Vocational programs.

Paul Ruseau: My son loved the rotation through electrical this year. Are there any specialized parts of the electrical program devoted to solar or car charging stations?

Rich Cormio: We introduce them to solar. We installed a charger a couple of years ago. We are adding more to the program in this area. We are also doing voice and data work. We are trying to keep up with the times.

Kathy Kreatz introducing John McLaughlin: MHS front entrance letter sign and walkway. At the last meeting, we discussed having an official main entrance with a sign. John got estimates and signed pictures.

John McLaughlin: I was surprised by the high cost of the estimates in the signage proposals. Ranging from \$21K to \$27K. I sent all of it to the Mayor's office. Went back to the vendor and got a basic sign for \$10K

Paulette Van der Kloot: I am wondering if the students can do this project: designing the sign and producing it using the various shops?

Mr. Chad Fallon: The Vocational programs are willing to help with some aspects however the scope of the project is out of their realm. We felt it was a bit beyond our scope.

It was unclear what direction the design was going in.

John McLaughlin: Chad helped us this afternoon at the front entrance.

Paulette Van der Kloot: The mayor liked one and four.

Kathy showing slides along with a poll

Poll: Options 6 and 7

We did two polls at the meeting to narrow down the sign options. The first poll we did there were three results: #6 rank 50%, # 7 rank 33%, & # 2 rank 17 %. Then in poll 2 we dropped out the lowest ranking sign # 2 and did the poll with just 6 & 7. 6 got results 57% #7 got results 43%. Sign # 6 was chosen as the preferred choice.

Kathy Kreatz: we want to have something similar to sign picture # 6 or sign picture # 7 but need to get price estimates. How about \$15K as a budget for a sign that could be made and taken down and transferred to a new school if a new school is built down the line.

Paul Ruseau: I am not interested in whether it is transferable and I am not interested in renovating the building

Kathy Kreatz: I make a recommendation to give the results to the full committee to see both sign pictures 6 and 7 and give the estimates we have received from White Lights.

John McLaughlin: I have to get the specific pricing for each option. I will reach out to him. It could be \$10K for a basic sign.

Paulette Van der Kloot: What is the sign made out of?

John McLaughlin: I am not sure. I can find out what the materials are. Seems like modern plastic.

Dr. Cushing: Would it be worthwhile to put it out to the students to vote on it?

Kathy Kreatz: I love that idea.

Dr. Cushing: I am the student outreach coordinator so I can work on getting this out to the students.

Paul Ruseau: I would just like to stick to the top three. We didn't like the new logo.

Paulette Van der Kloot: I would like to chat with carpentry and other shops about coming up with a sign too.

Kathy Kreatz: I made a recommendation to do a poll of the student body to pick one design option and Mr. McLaughlin can reach out to the shops and see what they could do to help and possibly keep the costs down?

John McLaughlin: In the MVTHS, the projects need to align with the curriculum but I will check with them.

Kathy Kreatz: Are we going to keep this in the subcommittee until after we talk to the shops and poll the students?

Paulette Van der Kloot: do we want it in place for the opening of school in September? I am hearing that we don't want to approve a \$20k sign.

Kathy Kreatz: Yes, we want the sign for the opening of the school in September

Kathy Kreatz: Motion for Dr. Cushing to do a poll with the student body (the top 3 signs ideas for MHS). The students could share their preferences/feedback. So, we can move forward with signage at MHS in place for September, the results from the subcommittee and student body poll will be shared at our upcoming school committee meeting on 6/14/21 for a vote by the committee.

Roll: 3 yes (Kathy Kreatz, Paulette Van der Kloot, Paul Ruseau) motion passes

John McLaughlin: It didn't include the electrical work but it did include the installation.

John McLaughlin: sharing landscaping updates. The Construction and Craft Labor students put down new mulch and low maintenance plants to rejuvenate, beautify the front driveway corner of Winthrop Street. Planting new heartier plants on Steve Miller drive but unfortunately no sprinkler system.

Kathy Kreatz showing pictures. McDonough Fence fixed the broken fence corner of Winthrop Street. Aggie Tuden helped with identifying problematic trees.

Aggie Tuden: We have planted 18 trees around the HS complex over the last year. Red maples.

Dr. Cushing: If sugar maples are available, the CTE students can tap into them. There are many schools offering horticulture classes.

Kathy Kreatz: Next item HS Bathrooms.

Dave Murphy: RFPs have been held up but they will be issued before the end of the school year with the hope that the work will be completed over the next three months.

Kathy Kreatz: I appreciate your getting the RFP out to get the work done over the summer months.

Kathy Kreatz: Next item Solar speed sign

John McLaughlin: Installed directly at crosswalk entrance to MHS as well as vocational school entrance. The third sign will be installed at the Andrews. They are set for ten miles an hour.

Kathy Kreatz: MHS Hot water system. I found it in the capital improvement plan on page 41. I asked John to get estimates which he shared with us. \$171K was one estimate. We will need to replace this system before students return to school in September. Currently no hot water in MHS.

John McLaughlin: Heat exchanger rotted out. The back half of the building has no hot water. I asked Irving plumbing for a quote. I reached out to Alicia Hunt to see if she could help. I had engineers at MHS scouting it out.

Alicia Hunt: We had an audit back in 2009 of all the schools. We are using the vendor who did the audit to look at it. Back in 2010, we got a green community grant at which point we replaced the systems. Two different parts of the building - so we only did the front half of the building. (Everything but cafeteria and gym). The pool showers have not had hot water but the showers haven't been used due to COVID. The system that has been there since 1969 is very difficult to replace. We need to size water heaters to

figure out what we need. Health department regulation. The kitchen - we got a grant to put in a commercial dishwasher so we need to scale the hot water heaters appropriately. We need this working for mid-August. Quote coming tonight. Spoke with procurement. As long as labor is below \$50k, we can stick to three quotes breaking out equipment and labor appropriately. Spoke about emergency waiver but in the past experience, you need to replace like for like.

Kathy Kreatz: Motion to move this over to the full committee.

Alicia Hunt: We can get some rebate money from the national grid on this. But it is not possible to turn it around that quickly. Green community grants are not possible because they don't open until September and we need this working for mid-August

Kathy Kreatz: Motion to proceed with the replacement of the system.

Paul Ruseau, do we need to be involved, and do we need to vote? Don't want to hold off until June 7 to proceed.

Alicia Hunt: I would have money in my budget to get us to the place to get a quote. I am hoping we have the discretion to hire an engineer and get the process going. We won't have the quotes by June 7.

Paul Ruseau: I would like for the finance dept. To decide whether we need to be involved. We might need to have an emergency meeting. I don't want to clog the process up.

Dave Murphy: This is one of those times when if you vote yes tonight, we can move forward. We have to spend money to do this. We anticipate having a surplus that could fund this and we have legal authority. A vote of confidence is appreciated but is not a precedent that an emergency repair needs to go to the school committee unless it takes money from something else.

Dave Murphy: Curtis tufts boiler, generator, water heaters, and bathrooms: RFPs all going out because of the money already appropriated from the city council.

Kathy Kreatz: Motion to vote on hot water heater: Seconded by Paulette Van der Kloot

Roll: 3 yes (Kathy Kreatz, Paulette Van der Kloot, Paul Ruseau) motion passes

The vote will be shared at the SC meeting.

Curtis Tufts HS boiler: sectional replacements. Not a full replacement.

Kathy Kreatz: Motion to proceed with the labor expense cost to repair the Curtis Tufts HS boiler: sectional replacements.

Roll: 3 yes (Kathy Kreatz, Paulette Van der Kloot, Paul Ruseau) motion passes

Kathy Kreatz Medford High School Generator at MHS - We have discussed this at the last couple of meetings. There is no further discussion necessary. The generator is not operational. It's very important and it needs to be replaced. If we lost power there would be no heat, electricity, and we would have to close the school. I recommend we go ahead with the replacement as soon as possible. Kathy Kreatz Motion to replace Generator, Seconded by Paulette Van der Kloot

Roll: 3 yes (Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Kathy Kreatz) motion Passes.

John McLaughlin: Next item: transformer out that services one-third of MHS. A long time about PCBs was taken out. The insurance audit suggested we test the oil in the system. I have to check whether I can hire someone for \$20K to fix it or if I have to get three quotes. It is certainly something we have to take care of.

Kathy Kreatz Motion to give John McLaughlin the ok to repair the transformer.
Seconded by Paulette Van der Kloot

Roll: 3 yes (Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Kathy Kreatz) motion Passes.

John McLaughlin: Provided the committee with an informational update capital cost associated with the MHS Pool Roof Replacement. The estimate he received from Garland Company the MHS Pool Roof Replacement \$575,000.00- \$600,000. He is just letting us know so we are aware. This will need to be done possibly in FY 2022

Kathy Kreatz: No emails to share.

Motion to adjourn: Paulette Van der Kloot seconded by Paul Ruseau

Roll: 3 yes (Paul Ruseau, Paulette Van der Kloot, Kathy Kreatz) motion passes.
Meeting adjourned